

Table 14: The signal against the risk gauges, one staircase of specifications per portfolio series. Specification: $y_t = a + b \mathbf{1}\{\text{signal}\}_{t-1} + \gamma' X_{t-1} + e_t$, with y the portfolio's annualized monthly return and X the controls of the column, namely (1) none; (2) NFCI level and one-month change—the NFCI exists from 1971, so this column covers the full 1988 sample; (3) VIX level and one-month change—the *VIX exists only from 1990 (the index's inception)*, so columns (3)–(4) begin 1990:12; (4) all four. All regressors lagged one month; changes are one-month (non-overlapping). The signal reports b (%/yr), Newey–West (12) t in parentheses, and the wild cluster bootstrap p on signal episodes in brackets (controls partialled under the null); the controls, being continuous, report b and t_{NW} only.

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
<i>Panel A: carry, spot</i>				
Signal	−12.85*** (−3.16) [0.001]	−12.84*** (−3.62) [<0.001]	−15.28*** (−3.00) [0.003]	−13.18*** (−2.95) [0.004]
NFCI (level)		+1.43 (+0.45)		−6.04 (−1.58)
ΔNFCI (1m)		−48.32 (−3.78)		−64.00 (−3.75)
VIX (level)			+0.26 (+1.17)	+0.64 (+2.47)
ΔVIX (1m)			−0.33 (−0.96)	+0.29 (+0.78)
N	458	458	423	423
<i>Panel B: carry, total</i>				
Signal	−11.31*** (−2.66) [0.003]	−11.56*** (−3.15) [<0.001]	−14.62*** (−2.86) [0.005]	−12.55*** (−2.77) [0.008]
NFCI (level)		+2.09 (+0.60)		−5.97 (−1.60)
ΔNFCI (1m)		−48.17 (−3.86)		−62.43 (−3.69)
VIX (level)			+0.25 (+1.13)	+0.62 (+2.40)
ΔVIX (1m)			−0.32 (−0.92)	+0.29 (+0.78)
N	458	458	423	423
<i>Panel C: high-beta, spot</i>				
Signal	−7.53*** (−2.66) [0.010]	−8.38** (−2.91) [0.011]	−9.59** (−2.86) [0.016]	−8.24** (−2.49) [0.025]
NFCI (level)		+3.16 (+0.97)		−3.73 (−1.04)
ΔNFCI (1m)		−29.99 (−2.44)		−44.12 (−2.84)
VIX (level)			+0.42 (+1.91)	+0.66 (+3.43)
ΔVIX (1m)			−0.31 (−0.97)	+0.13 (+0.37)
N	458	458	423	423
<i>Panel D: high-beta, total</i>				
Signal	−6.82** (−2.36) [0.013]	−7.86** (−2.74) [0.013]	−9.22** (−2.78) [0.016]	−7.95** (−2.43) [0.025]
NFCI (level)		+3.66 (+1.06)		−3.34 (−0.91)
ΔNFCI (1m)		−30.32 (−2.52)		−43.67 (−2.82)
VIX (level)			+0.43 (+1.95)	+0.65 (+3.46)
ΔVIX (1m)			−0.31 (−0.97)	+0.14 (+0.37)